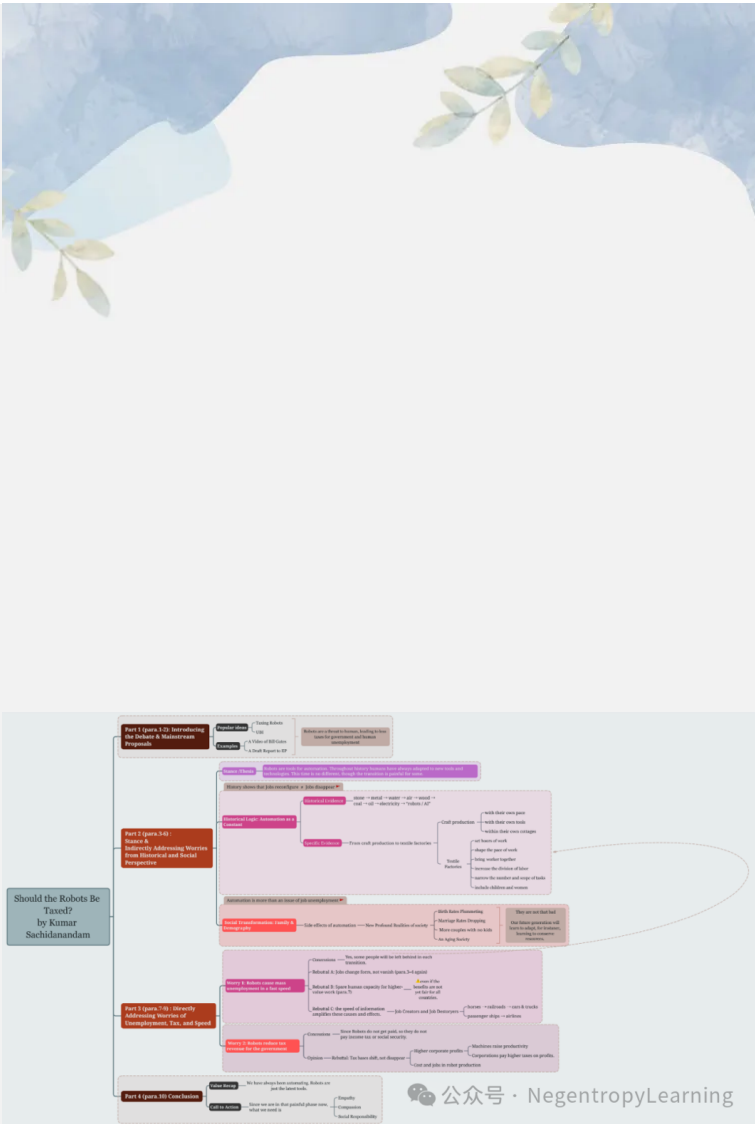


Day 42 机器人，是威胁吗？

绒花儿 NegentropyLearning 2025年11月9日 18:43 四川



Part 01

Para 1. Sentence 1

A video of Bill Gates suggesting that robots **should be taxed** is going viral in the news and social media. (para.1)

Words

★ **go viral:** 大火；用来形容某个内容（视频、图片、文章、帖子等）在网络上被大量转发、分享和讨论，迅速获得极高的曝光度和关注度。

[SYN] blow up; catch on; take off; blow across the internet / all over the internet; become a hit; gain widespread attention online

Para 2. Sentence 1

This idea of universal income and taxing robots **is gaining ground**. (para. 2)

Words

★ **gain ground:** 取得进展 / 逐步占据优势

[SYN] make headway; take hold; make progress

Sacred Draughts

🧠 **UBI = Universal Basic Income (全民基本收入)**

由政府定期、无条件地向所有公民（或居民）发放固定金额的钱，不论其收入、就业状况或财富水平。

e.g. 芬兰 (2017—2018): 对 2000 名失业者发放基本收入，每月 560 欧元。结果：幸福感提升，但就业促进效果有限。

Universal basic income (UBI)^[note 1] is a **social welfare** proposal in which all **citizens** of a given population regularly receive a minimum **income** in the form of an unconditional **transfer payment**, i.e., without a **means test** or need to perform **work**.^{[2][3]}
^[4] In contrast, a **guaranteed minimum income** is paid only to those who do not already receive an income that is enough to live on. A UBI would be received independently of any other income. If the level is sufficient to meet a person's basic needs (i.e., at or above the **poverty line**), it is considered a **full basic income**; if it is less than that amount, it is called a **partial basic income**.^[5] As of 2025, no country has implemented a full UBI system, but two countries—**Mongolia** and **Iran**—have had a partial UBI in the past.^[6] There have been **numerous pilot projects**,^[7] and the idea is **discussed in many countries**. Some have labelled UBI as **utopian** due to its historical origin.^{[8][9][10]}



3-minute video on universal basic income (2013)



Para 2. Sentence 2

Sometime in June, a draft report **was submitted** to the European Parliament that **states**. (para. 2)

Words

★ **submit** [v.]: 提交 / 服从 / 屈服 (后跟 to) | 认为, 主张 (较正式)

★ **state** [v.]: 陈述 / 说明

[SYN] declare; assert; affirm; announce; remark; mention; point out

! “sometime、some time、sometimes” 和 “some times” 的主要区别:

“sometime” 的意思是 “某个时间”;

分开的 “some time” 表示 “一段时间”;

频度副词 “sometimes” 表示 “有时”;

而分开的 “some times” 则指 “几次, 几回”。

Sacred Draughts

European Parliament

欧洲议会 (European Parliament) 是欧盟的直接民选立法机构, 代表约 4.5 亿欧盟公民的利益。

The **European Parliament** (EP) is one of the two **legislative bodies** of the **European Union** (EU) and one of its **seven institutions**. Together with the **Council of the European Union** (known as the Council and informally as the Council of Ministers), it adopts European legislation, following a proposal by the **European Commission**. The Parliament is composed of **720 members** (MEPs), after the June 2024 European elections, from a previous 705 MEPs. It represents the second-largest democratic electorate in the world (after the **Parliament of India**), with an electorate of around 375 million eligible **voters** in 2024.^{[4][5][6]}

Since 1979, the Parliament has been directly elected every five years by the **citizens of the European Union** through **universal suffrage**. **Voter turnout** in parliamentary elections decreased each time after 1979 until 2019, when voter turnout increased by eight percentage points, and rose above 50% for the first time since 1994.^[7] The **voting age** is 18 in all **EU member states** except for **Malta**, **Belgium**, **Austria** and **Germany**, where it is 16, and **Greece**, where it is 17.^[8]

European Parliament	
[show]	
10th European Parliament	
	
Type	
Type	De facto lower house of bicameral legislature
Term limits	None
History	
Founded	10 September 1952; 73 years ago
Preceded by	Common Assembly of the European Coal and Steel Community
Leadership	

Para. 2. Sentence 3

If advanced robots **start** replacing human workers in large numbers, the report **recommends** the European Commission **force** their owners to pay taxes or contribute to social security. (para. 2)

Words

★ **advanced** [adj.]: 高阶/先进的 (水平高、技术新) | 晚期/进展到较晚阶段 (疾病、项目、怀孕等) | 年事已高的 | 发达/高度发展的

★ **recommend** [v.]: 推荐、建议 ~ sb. to do/ ~ doing sth

Sacred Draughts

European Commission 欧洲联盟委员会

是欧洲联盟的主要行政机关，为欧盟事实上的内阁。欧盟委员会由 27 位执委组成，首长为欧盟委员会主席。



European Council（欧洲理事会）：成员国领导人开会定大方向。

Council of the EU（欧盟理事会）：各国部长级，与欧洲议会一起立法。

European Parliament（欧洲议会）：直接选举产生的立法机构。

European Commission（欧盟委员会）：像政府，提案+执行+执法。

The European Commission (EC) is the primary executive branch of the European Union (EU). It operates as a cabinet government, with a number of members of the Commission (directorial system, informally known as "commissioners") corresponding to two thirds of the number of member states, unless the European Council, acting unanimously, decides to alter this number.^[1] The current number of commissioners is 27, including the president.^{[2][3]} It includes an administrative body of about 32,000 European civil servants. The commission is divided into departments known as Directorates-General (DGs) that can be likened to departments or ministries each headed by a director-general who is responsible to a commissioner. Currently, there is one member per member state, but members are bound by their oath of office to represent the general interest of the EU as a whole rather than their home state.^[4] The Commission president (currently Ursula von der Leyen) is proposed by the European Council^[5] (the 27 heads of state/governments) and elected by the European Parliament.^[6] The Council of the European Union then nominates the other members of the Commission in agreement with the nominated president, and the 27 members as a team are then subject to a vote of approval by the European Parliament.^[7]																					
European Commission Name in official languages [show]  European Commission Overview <table><tr><td>Established</td><td>16 January 1958; 67 years ago</td></tr><tr><td>Country</td><td>27 member states [show]</td></tr><tr><td>Polity</td><td>European Union</td></tr><tr><td>Leader</td><td>President of the Commission (Ursula von der Leyen since 1 December 2019)</td></tr><tr><td>Appointed by</td><td>Nominated by the European Council and elected by the European Parliament</td></tr><tr><td>Main organ</td><td>College of Commissioners</td></tr><tr><td>Ministries</td><td>33 [show]</td></tr><tr><td>Responsible to</td><td>European Parliament</td></tr><tr><td>Headquarters</td><td>Brussels, Belgium Luxembourg City, Luxembourg</td></tr><tr><td>Website</td><td>commission.europa.eu</td></tr></table>		Established	16 January 1958; 67 years ago	Country	27 member states [show]	Polity	European Union	Leader	President of the Commission (Ursula von der Leyen since 1 December 2019)	Appointed by	Nominated by the European Council and elected by the European Parliament	Main organ	College of Commissioners	Ministries	33 [show]	Responsible to	European Parliament	Headquarters	Brussels, Belgium Luxembourg City, Luxembourg	Website	commission.europa.eu
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Grammar

💡 注意这里 If + 一般现在时，表示将来可能发生的情况

💡 the report recommends ...(后接省略that的宾语从句)

💡 宾语从句里省略的 should

👉 recommend / suggest / demand 等常用虚拟语气，完整应为：the European Commission (should) force...

Para. 2, Sentence 4

*The establishment of a basic income, or guaranteed welfare program, **is also suggested** as a protection against human unemployment. (para. 2)*

Words

🌟 **establishment** [n.] 机构/单位/店家 | **建立/确立** | 建制既定制度) | (大写) 当权派

🌟 **guarantee** [v.] : **确保/担保/保证**) Certain to happen or be provided; secured by a formal

or legal promise.

Part 02

Para 3, Sentence 1

I see robots as tools [主句]
that make a job easier or do things much faster or much better or much cheaper. (para. 3) [定语从句]

Words

 **see...as...**: 把 A 看作 B / 认为 A 是 B
[SYN] regard as; treat as; consider sb. to be...

Para 3, Sentence 2

Throughout human history, we have used various forms of tools, from stone to metal to water to air to wood to coal to oil, and to electricity to achieve transformations in our lives. (para. 3)

Words

 **transformation [n.]**: 社会 / 政治 / 经济上的转型; 个人 / 生活上的巨大变化 [强调“质变”, 彻底、结构性的改变]

Para 3, Sentence 3

During each of these stages, [介词短语作背景状语]
there were a lot of people [主句]
who lost their jobs and the next generation learned new skills to stay relevant. [定语从句] (para. 3)

Words

★ **relevant [adj.]:** 相关的, 有关的; 有意义的, 切题的(常用在 “stay relevant” = 保持不被淘汰, 保持有价值 / 有竞争力。)



related → 单纯“有关联”, 但不一定重要

relevant → 不但有关, 而且“有意义、切题、必要”

Para. 3, Sentence 4

A case in point is below: Textile factories **organized** workers' lives much differently from craft production. (para. 3)

📌 Words

★ A case in point

[SYN]: For instance/for example; a notable/striking example is...; To illustrate; Consider...; as evidenced/demonstrated in...; Take...as an example...

★ **textile[n.]:** 纺织品, 织物

★ **craft [n.]:** 手工艺, 工艺, 技巧; 船 (单复数同形 craft)

★ **craft production:** 手工业

📌 Sacred Draughts

🧠 Craft production vs Textile factories

这句话其实反映了 工业革命时期的一大转变:

Craft production (手工业生产): 工人往往在家里或小作坊工作, 自主性高。

Textile factories (纺织工厂): 集中生产, 严格分工和时间管理, 工人生活被“工厂制度”重组。

这是 工业化从“手工艺经济”向“工厂经济”转变 的一个典型案例。

Para. 3, Sentence 5

Handloom weavers **worked** at their own pace, with their own tools, and within their own cottages. (para. 3)

📌 Words

★ **handloom [n.]:** 手织机

⚠️ **loom [v.]** 动词 (不及物): 隐约显现; (常指不祥地) 逼近、临近

★ **weaver** [n.]: 织工, 织布工人

★ **pace** [n.]: 速度 / 步伐 / 步距



keep pace with (跟上) : Schools must keep pace with technology.

set the pace (定下节奏/行业标杆) : This startup sets the pace in robotics.

pick up the pace (加快) / at a snail's pace (蜗牛速度)

change of pace (节奏/风格的改变)

★ **cottage** [n.]: 小屋, 乡间小屋

★ **cottage industry** = 在家里用简陋工具进行的小规模生产 (比如织布、手工艺)

Para 3, Sentence 6

Factories **set** hours of work, and the machinery within them **shaped** the pace of work. (para. 3)

📌 Words

★ **machinery** [n.]: 机器, 机械 (集合名词) ; 复杂的过程/运转

Para 3, Sentence 7

Factories **brought** workers together within one building to work on machinery [主句]
that they **did not own**. (para. 3) [定语从句]

Para 3, Sentence 8

Factories also **increased** the division of labor. (para. 3)

📌 Sacred Draughts

🧠 the division of labor = 分工

👉 指社会或组织中, 不同个体/群体根据专长或角色分配任务, 以提高效率。

👉 亚当·斯密 (Adam Smith) 在《国富论》中著名的“针厂例子”: 如果一个人从头到尾做一根针, 效率很低; 如果把过程分成多个步骤 (拉丝、切割、磨尖等), 每个人只负责一步, 产量能提高几百倍。

Para. 3. Sentence 9

They narrowed the number and scope of tasks. (para. 3)

Words

 **scope** [n.]: 范围、领域; 机会、余地、能力; 视野、观察范围

Para. 3. Sentence 10

*They **included** children and women within a common production process*

Sacred Draughts

Main idea of para. 3

第三自然段的核心意思：科技进步带来生产方式与社会结构的深刻变化 —— 有人失业，但社会通过重新分工和技能适应继续前进。

////////////////////////////////////

Para. 4. Sentence 1

*While weavers **lost** their jobs, [while 引导让步状语从句]
their kids and families **got** their jobs in factories and in other firms. (para. 4) [主句]*

Para. 4. Sentence 2

*Now that the factories **are getting** closed and replaced with robots, [Now that 引导的原因状语从句]
factory workers' kids **might become** knowledge workers. (para. 4) [主句]*

Words

 **now that** = 既然/由于 (强调新情况已出现)

比 because 更强调“形势/背景的变化”，常见于新闻、评论、正式说明文

Sacred Draughts

Signals of the clause of cause

since; for; as; now that; given that; considering that...; inasmuch as...; insofar as... + 句子
because of, due to, owing to, thanks to, on account of, in view of, in light of, as a result of
+ doing

这句话延续了前文的逻辑：

工业革命 → 织工失业 → 子女进入工厂

现在 → 工厂工人失业 → 子女可能转向“知识工作”

👉 说明技术进步 = 劳动力结构的代际转型。

Para 4. Sentence 3

But there **will always be** a lag and some population **will be left behind**. (para. 4)

📌 Words

★ **lag** [n.] 延迟, 滞后

jet lag → 时差反应; economic lag → 经济滞后

Part 03

Para 5. Sentence 1

The side effect of automation **was** the number of families and kids in our families. (para.5)

📌 Words

★ **side effect** [n.] 副作用 (医学最常见用法); 附带影响, 额外效果

adverse side effect → 不良副作用

positive side effect → 积极的附带效果

[SYN] 负面后果 → repercussion, ramification, fallout, knock-on effect

★ **automation** [n.] The use of machines and technology to perform tasks without human labor. **自动化**; 指通过技术和设备完成任务, 减少人工干预

Para 5. Sentence 2

When muscle power **was** strength, [时间状语从句]
the number of kids in a family, and the number of men in particular, **was a sign of**
prosperity. [主句] (para.5)

📌 Words

★ **muscle power:** Physical strength or manual labor used to do work, especially before machines. 人力、体力劳动；指靠人或动物的肌肉力量完成工作的时代

★ **prosperity** [n.] 繁荣、昌盛、兴旺（最常见）；富裕、成功（个人层面）

📌 Grammar

💡 the number of +V 单 “...的数量”

a number of + V复 “许多，一些”

Para 5, Sentence 3

*However, as we **went through** this progress, [时间状语从句]*

*the birth rate **plummeted** [主句1]*

*and it **is** worth watching other social trends like more single people, lower marriage rates, more married couples with no kids, etc. [主句2] (para.5)*

📌 Words

★ **go through** : 经历，遭受；仔细检查，审阅

[SYN]: experience; undergo



sth. be worth doing 评价“这事值得做”（强调价值/成本收益）

be worthy of doing 更正式，带“配得上、值得被...”的评价色彩，常接名词；指人也常用“be worthy to do（有资格去做）”

★ **plummet** [v.]: 暴跌，骤降



上升:

rise/increase/grow

climb/improve/jump

surge/rocket/soar/shoot up



下降

fall/drop/decline/decrease

reduce/diminish/lessen/sink

plummet/plunge/slump/nosedive

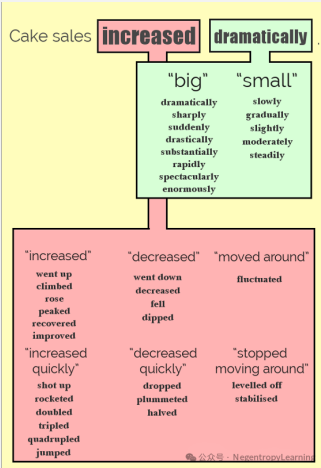


描述趋势常用副词/形容词

gradually / steadily / slowly → 缓慢地

significantly / considerably → 显著地

dramatically / sharply / steeply → 急剧地
slightly / marginally → 轻微地



Para 6, Sentence 1

The world **is also seeing** another trend! (para. 6)

Para 6, Sentence 2

It **is getting** older. (para. 6)

Para 6, Sentence 3

But an older population **may not be** as bad as we think (it is).(para. 6)

📌 Grammar

as bad as we think: 表语（程度比较结构 as...as）。核心形容词 bad，后面的 we think 为省略成分的从句，完整为 we think (it is)，即“如我们所想的（那样糟）”。

Para 6, Sentence 4

One theory **is** [主句]
that our future generation **will live** in a resource-constrained world and
therefore **learn** to conserve resources. [表语从句] (para. 6)

📌 Words

🌟 **resource-constrained** : 资源受限的（学术用语，常见于经济、可持续发展话题）。

🌟 **constrain** [v.]: 限制、约束；强迫、迫使



constrain: 多为环境/条件造成的“逼迫/限制”; 常见搭配 be constrained by/to。也可表示“被迫做”。

restrain: 多为人/制度/力量的“克制/遏制/阻止”; 常见搭配 restrain sb/sth from (doing)。

★ **conserve [v.]** 保护、保存 (自然资源/环境); 节约 (能源/资源); 保存、保留 (保持某种性质/特征)

! conservation area 保护区

conserve = 小心使用以避免浪费 (强调节约、合理利用)

preserve = 保存不变, 防止破坏或消失 (强调完整保存)

reserve = 留出、保留供以后使用

////////////////////////////////////

Para 7. Sentence 1

As Bill Gates **argues**, [方式/Adverbial Clause of Reference]
spare human capacity **has already been put** to better use to provide education and
research leading to even better knowledge, health care and wealth for all of us. (para.
7) [主句]

Words

★ **spare [adj.]** 多余的

★ **argue [v.]:** 提出观点 / 主张 / 辩称 / 论证

[SYN]: maintain; contend; assert; claim; insist; emphasize; stress; suggest; point out; state; note

Para 7. Sentence 2

However, **this has not been uniform** [主句]
as the per capita income growth **has been skewed** toward developed
nations. (para. 7) [原因状语从句]

Words

★ **per capita =** 人均的

★ **skew /skju:/[v.]:** 使倾斜 / 歪曲 / 偏向

! tilt = 倾向, 强调动态趋势, 语气中性。

skew = 偏斜/失衡, 强调结果不均衡或扭曲, 语气多负面。

as引导的从句

1) 时间状语从句 (as = when/while,时/随着)

e.g. As the sun rose, the fog lifted.

2) 原因状语从句 (as = because/since, 因为/既然)

e.g. As it's raining, we'll stay in.

3) 方式/类比状语从句 (as = just as/ the way, 正如/按照.....方式)

e.g. As I used (as a child) to play I was Napoleon or a trapper

4) 让步状语从句 (倒装 as) (Adj./Adv./N./PP + as + S + V, 尽管/虽说)

e.g. Blessed as I was with a "bad memory," I could not commit to it anything that I did not understand and intellectually need.

5) 比较/对应关系从句 (相关比较 as...so...; 或与主句呼应的“as”)

But an older population may not be as bad as we think (it is).

Part 04

Para 8, Sentence 1

The biggest argument [Bill Gates **makes** (省略that的定语从句) **is** on the taxes. (para. 8)

Para 8, Sentence 2

As machines **are replacing** human workers, [原因状语从句]
these robots **don't get paid** [主句1]
and this **leads** to the lower taxes for the government. [主句2](para. 8)

Para 8, Sentence 3

But [what we **fail** to see (名词性从句/主语从句) **is**
that, [this also **leads** to higher profits for corporations (表语从句) ,
which **pay** higher taxes (非限制性定语从句)]. (para. 8)

Para 8, Sentence 4

Also, **there is a cost** to making robots and investing in such technologies. (para. 8)

Words

★ **there is a cost to doing sth.** = 做某事需要付出代价/成本

Para 8, Sentence 5

This creates
a different kind of job,
different levels of salaries
and different taxes, maybe in a different part of the country or in different parts of
the world altogether.(para. 8)

Para 8, Sentence 6

Now, **that's a flashpoint**. (para. 8)

Words

★ **flashpoint [n.]:** 导火索, 爆发点

Para 8, Sentence 7

But **this too shall pass**.(para. 8)

Para 8, Sentence 8

We have seen the era of boycotting machine-made fabric and automobiles [主句]
when they **were seen** as a threat at some point. [时间状语从句] (para. 8)

Words

★ **boycott [v.]:** 抵制

“boycott”一词来自爱尔兰 19 世纪的一个故事：

英国土地代理人 Charles Boycott 因为盘剥农民，被当地人一致孤立和拒绝交易。

Para 8, Sentence 9

Today, **they have become an essential part** of our lives. (para. 8)

Words

★ **essential [adj.]** 必不可少的；极其重要的；本质的（构成事物核心所必需）

Para 9, Sentence 1

*I **hear** people complaining about the speed [主句]
at which these changes **happen** [定语从句]
and that we **are unable** to provide jobs or create newer skills. [宾语从句] (para. 9)*

Para 9, Sentence 2

*But, **think of** the speed [主句1: 祈使句]
at which horses **were replaced** by rail roads, cars and trucks; [定语从句]
the speed [省略共同谓语的主句2]
at which passenger ships **were replaced** by airlines. [定语从句] (para. 9)*

Para 9, Sentence 3

*They **must have been** pretty dramatic changes in those days! (para. 9)*

📌 Words

★ **dramatic [adj.]:** 戏剧性的；引人注目的；巨大的；夸张的，做作的

Para 9, Sentence 4

*These **were** huge job destroyers and also job creators of the other type.*

Para 9, Sentence 5

*In all cases, **those** [who **lost** their jobs (定语从句)] **did not find work** in the new industry. (para. 9)*

Para 9, Sentence 6

*It **was** a new breed of skills that **found** these jobs. [强调句] (para. 9)*

Para 9, Sentence 7

*But it **took** some time. (para. 9)*

Para 9, Sentence 8

*These **are** very visible today because of the speed [主句]
at which information **travels** today, amplifying these causes and effects. [定语从句]*

Words

★ **amplify [v.]**: 放大（声音/信号）; 增强，扩大（效果/影响/程度）; 详细说明，阐述

Part 05

Para 10. Sentence 1

*In summary, I **would argue** [主句]
that we **have always been** automating. [宾语从句]*

Para 10. Sentence 2

*I **see** the world as a system [主句 1]
and when the system **gets disrupted**, [时间状语从句]
it **takes a while** to get to the equilibrium [主句 2]
and that **is** painful. [主句 3]*

Words

★ **disrupt [v.]**: 打乱，干扰；颠覆，改变（中性/积极）（在商业、科技语境中，disrupt 往往指“颠覆式创新”）

★ **equilibrium [n.]**: 平衡

Para 10. Sentence 3

*We **are going through** that painful phase now and it **needs** empathy, compassion
and social responsibility.*

Words

★ **empathy [n.]**: 同理心；共情

★ **compassion [n.]**: 同情；怜悯；慈悲



empathy = 我感受到你的感受（共情，代入感最强）

sympathy = 我为你难过（情感支持，但未必感同身受）

compassion = 我想帮你减轻痛苦（带行动的慈悲）

-END-